

ANKOLE SOFT DRINKS LTD
Buhweju District, Uganda

BEVERAGE INVENTORY AND SALES MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

COMPREHENSIVE USER MANUAL

Version	1.0
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Developed by	Metropolitan International University
System	BISMS — Beverage Inventory & Sales Management System
Organisation	Ankole Soft Drinks Ltd, Buhweju District, Uganda

■ **IMPORTANT** This manual covers all modules of the BISMS system. Distribute to all staff who use the system. Keep a printed copy available at the reception desk.

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1. INTRODUCTION & SYSTEM OVERVIEW

1.1 What is BISMS?

The Beverage Inventory and Sales Management System (BISMS) is a secure, web-based application designed specifically for Ankole Soft Drinks Ltd. It replaces manual paper-based record-keeping with a centralised digital platform that manages every aspect of the business — from receiving stock from suppliers to invoicing customers and generating management reports.

1.2 What the System Does

- Tracks all beverage products, brands, sizes, and packaging types
- Records stock received from suppliers and automatically increases inventory
- Processes sales and automatically deducts sold quantities from stock
- Manages customer accounts, credit limits, and outstanding balances
- Maintains a complete record of every payment received
- Provides low-stock alerts before products run out
- Generates sales, inventory, and financial reports with CSV export
- Enforces role-based access so each staff member only sees what they need
- Keeps a full audit trail of every important action in the system

1.3 Who Uses the System?

Administrator	Full access to all modules including user management and system settings
Manager	All operational modules — can approve adjustments and override credit limits
Sales Officer	Create and view sales, manage customers, record payments
Store Officer	Manage products, receive stock, request stock adjustments
Accountant	View sales, record payments, access financial reports

1.4 Key Terms

SKU	Stock Keeping Unit — a unique code for each product (e.g. PEPS-500ML)
Stock Movement	Any change in stock level — purchase, sale, adjustment, damage
Reorder Level	Minimum stock quantity that triggers a low-stock alert
Credit Limit	Maximum amount a customer can owe at any one time
Audit Trail	Automatic log of who did what and when in the system

UGX	Ugandan Shillings — the currency used throughout the system
DRAFT	A purchase order created but delivery not yet confirmed
RECEIVED	A purchase where delivery is confirmed and stock updated
Invoice	A document recording a sale with a unique invoice number

2. ACCESSING THE SYSTEM

2.1 System Requirements

BISMS runs entirely in a web browser. No software installation is required on your phone or computer.

- Any modern browser: Chrome, Firefox, Edge, or Safari
- Internet connection (the system is hosted on Render cloud)
- A valid username and password provided by your Administrator

2.2 Logging In

1	Open your web browser and go to the system URL provided by your Administrator
2	The login page appears. Enter your Username in the first field
3	Enter your Password in the second field
4	Tick 'Remember Me' if you are on a private office computer — do NOT tick on shared devices
5	Click the green 'Sign In' button
6	You will be taken directly to the Dashboard

■ **TIP** If the page takes about 30 seconds to load on first visit, this is normal — the free hosting plan sleeps when unused. It wakes up automatically.

2.3 Logging Out

Always log out when you finish, especially on shared computers.

- Click Sign out at the bottom of the left sidebar
- OR click the Sign out button in the top-right corner

2.4 Changing Your Password

1	Click the key icon in the top navigation bar, or click "Password" in the sidebar footer
2	Enter your Current Password
3	Enter your New Password — minimum 8 characters, mix letters and numbers
4	Confirm New Password by typing it again
5	Click 'Change Password'

■■ **WARNING** Change your password immediately after your first login. Never share your password with colleagues.

2.5 Navigating the System

Left Sidebar	Main navigation menu — click any item to go to that module
Top Bar	Shows the current page name; quick action buttons on the right
Breadcrumb Bar	Shows exactly where you are — e.g. Home > Sales > INV-001
Mobile	Tap the  menu icon to open the sidebar. Tap outside to close it

3. DASHBOARD

The Dashboard is the first page you see after logging in. It gives a live overview of the entire business.

3.1 KPI Cards

Active Products	Total number of products currently active in the system
Total Stock Units	Sum of all units currently in stock across all products
Sales Today	Number of sales transactions recorded today
Revenue Today	Total money earned from sales today (UGX)
Revenue This Month	Total revenue for the current calendar month (UGX)
Outstanding Balances	Total amount owed by customers on credit sales (UGX)
Stock Value	Total value of all current inventory at cost price (UGX)
Low Stock Items	Number of products at or below their reorder level

3.2 Low Stock Alerts Panel

Lists all products at or below their reorder level. These need urgent restocking.

- Zero stock shown in RED — cannot be sold, order immediately
- Low stock shown in YELLOW — can still sell but needs a purchase order
- Click 'View All' to go to the full Inventory Alerts page

3.3 Recent Sales & Recent Purchases

Shows the 6 most recent transactions of each type. Click any invoice or PO number to open its full detail, record a payment, or process a return.

3.4 Top Products

Lists the 5 best-selling products over the last 30 days by units sold. Use this to understand which products drive the most volume.

4. PRODUCTS MODULE

The Products module manages your complete beverage catalogue. You must set up products before you can create any sales or purchases.

4.1 IMPORTANT: Setup Order

■ **IMPORTANT** Always set up in this order: 1) Categories → 2) Units → 3) Products → 4) Opening Stock. Skipping this order will cause errors.

4.2 Setting Up Categories

1	Go to Products → Categories (button in breadcrumb bar)
2	Review existing categories — 5 defaults are created automatically: Soft Drinks, Energy Drinks, Water, Juice, Other
3	Click New Category to add any additional categories
4	Enter the Name (required) and optional Description
5	Click Save

4.3 Setting Up Units of Measure

1	Go to Products → Units
2	Default units: Piece (pcs), Crate (crt), Case (cs), Litre (L), Millilitre (ml)
3	Click New Unit to add more (e.g. Bottle / btl)
4	Enter Name and Symbol, then Save

4.4 Adding a New Product

1	Click New Product in the breadcrumb bar
2	Enter the SKU — a short unique code you create, e.g. PEPS-500ML or COKE-1L. The SKU cannot be changed after saving.
3	Enter the full Product Name, e.g. Pepsi 500ml Plastic Bottle
4	Select the Category from the dropdown
5	Select the Unit (Piece for single items, Crate for crates, etc.)
6	Optionally select Packaging type (Bottle, Can, Plastic Bottle, etc.)
7	Enter Brand (e.g. Pepsi, Coca-Cola) and Size (e.g. 500ml, 1L, 2L)

8	Enter Cost Price — what you pay the supplier in UGX. No commas.
9	Enter Selling Price — what you charge customers. Must be $\geq$ cost price.
10	Enter Reorder Level — minimum stock before low-stock alert. Recommend 1-2 crates.
11	Tick 'Track Expiry' if this product has expiry dates
12	Click 'Create Product'

■ **IMPORTANT** After creating a product, its stock starts at 0. You **MUST** set opening stock through Inventory → Adjustments. See Section 5.3.

4.5 Product Fields Reference

SKU	Unique code — set once, cannot be changed (e.g. PEPS-500ML)
Product Name	Full descriptive name shown in sales and reports
Category	Product grouping (Soft Drinks, Water, Juice, etc.)
Unit	How the product is counted (Piece, Crate, Case)
Packaging	Physical container type (Bottle, Can, Plastic Bottle)
Brand	Manufacturer brand (Pepsi, Coca-Cola, Riham, etc.)
Size	Volume or size (500ml, 1L, 330ml, 2L)
Cost Price	Your purchase price from supplier (UGX)
Selling Price	Price charged to customers — must be $\geq$ cost price
Reorder Level	Minimum stock before a low-stock alert is triggered
Track Expiry	Enable to monitor expiry dates for this product
Active	Inactive products cannot be sold but history is preserved

5. INVENTORY MODULE

The Inventory module is the heart of the system. It shows current stock levels for all products and provides tools to manage, adjust, and audit your stock.

5.1 Inventory Overview

Go to Inventory in the sidebar. The table shows every product with stock quantity (red = out, yellow = low, green = OK), reorder level, stock value, and status.

5.2 Stock Movements — The Audit Trail

Go to Inventory → Movements. This is the complete permanent record of every stock change. It cannot be edited.

PURCHASE	Stock increased when a purchase order was confirmed received
SALE	Stock reduced when a sale was completed
SALE_RETURN	Stock restored when a customer returned goods
PURCHASE_RETURN	Stock reduced when goods were returned to a supplier
ADJUSTMENT_IN	Stock increased by an approved manager adjustment
ADJUSTMENT_OUT	Stock reduced by an approved manager adjustment
DAMAGE	Stock written off due to physical damage
EXPIRY	Stock written off due to passing expiry date
LOSS	Stock written off due to theft or unexplained loss

5.3 Setting Opening Stock (First-Time Setup)

Do this ONCE for each product when you first set up the system.

1	Go to Inventory → Adjustments → Request Adjustment
2	Select the Product from the dropdown
3	Set Adjustment Type to IN (increasing stock)
4	Enter the Quantity — your actual physical count of that product
5	Enter Reason: Opening balance — initial stock entry
6	Click 'Submit for Approval'
7	A Manager or Administrator must go to Inventory → Adjustments and click ✓ to Approve
8	Once approved, the stock level updates immediately

- 9 Repeat for each product

■ **IMPORTANT** Opening stock requires Manager or Administrator approval. The Store Officer submits the request; the Manager approves it.

5.4 Stock Adjustments

Adjustments correct discrepancies between the system record and actual physical stock. All require a reason and manager approval.

Requesting an Adjustment:

- 1 Go to Inventory → Adjustments → Request Adjustment
- 2 Select the Product
- 3 Choose Type: IN (to increase) or OUT (to decrease)
- 4 Enter the Quantity to adjust by — this is the CHANGE, not the new total
- 5 Enter a clear Reason (minimum 5 characters)
- 6 Click 'Submit for Approval'

Approving an Adjustment (Manager/Admin only):

- 1 Go to Inventory → Adjustments
- 2 Find the PENDING adjustment in the list
- 3 Click ✓ to Approve (stock updates immediately) or ✗ to Reject

■■ **WARNING** Never approve adjustments you requested yourself without a second review. Large adjustments should always be verified against a physical count.

5.5 Recording Losses, Damage & Expiry

- 1 Go to Inventory → Record Loss / Damage
- 2 Select the Product
- 3 Select Loss Type: Damage, Expiry, or Loss/Theft
- 4 Enter the Quantity written off
- 5 Enter a clear Reason describing what happened
- 6 Click 'Record Loss' — stock is reduced immediately

5.6 Physical Stock Count

1	Go to Inventory → Stock Counts → New Stock Count
2	For each product, enter the Counted Qty — what you physically counted
3	Leave blank for any product you did not count
4	The Variance column shows the difference automatically
5	Add a Reason for any variance if known
6	Click 'Submit Stock Count'
7	Manager reviews and clicks 'Approve & Apply'
8	All variances are applied as stock adjustments automatically

5.7 Stock Alerts

Go to Inventory → Stock Alerts.

- OUT OF STOCK (red) — quantity is 0, cannot be sold. Create a purchase order immediately.
- LOW STOCK (yellow) — quantity is at or below reorder level. Order soon.

■ **TIP** Set realistic reorder levels. A product that sells 10 units per day needs a reorder level of at least 20-30 to allow time for delivery.

6. PURCHASES MODULE

Manages the ordering and receiving of stock from suppliers. Stock levels are only updated when a delivery is confirmed as received.

6.1 Purchase Workflow

1	Create a Purchase Order (DRAFT) listing products and quantities ordered
2	When the delivery arrives, open the purchase and click Confirm Receipt
3	Stock levels increase automatically for all received items
4	A stock movement record (PURCHASE) is created for each item

6.2 Creating a Purchase Order

1	Go to Purchases → New Purchase
2	Select the Supplier from the dropdown
3	Enter the Supplier Invoice Number from the delivery note — optional but recommended
4	Click 'Add Item' to add each product ordered
5	For each line: select Product, enter Quantity ordered, enter Unit Cost (price per unit)
6	The Line Total and Grand Total calculate automatically
7	Add Notes if needed
8	Click 'Create Purchase Order'

■ **IMPORTANT** A DRAFT purchase order does NOT affect stock. Stock only changes when you confirm receipt.

6.3 Confirming Stock Receipt

1	Go to Purchases and find the order with status DRAFT
2	Click the Purchase Number to open the detail page
3	Verify the items and quantities match what was delivered
4	Click 'Confirm Receipt'
5	Confirm the prompt — stock increases immediately for all items

■ **TIP** If the delivery is incomplete, still confirm receipt for what arrived. Note the discrepancy. Create a separate purchase order for missing items.

6.4 Purchase Returns

1	Open the purchase order (status must be RECEIVED)
2	Click 'Process Return' in the breadcrumb bar
3	Enter the Reason for the return
4	Enter the Return Quantity for each affected item
5	Click 'Process Return' — stock is reduced and a PURCHASE_RETURN movement is recorded

6.5 Purchase Status Reference

DRAFT	Purchase order created — delivery not yet confirmed. Stock NOT changed.
RECEIVED	Delivery confirmed — stock has been updated. Cannot undo.
CANCELLED	Order cancelled — no stock change recorded.

7. SALES MODULE

Records every transaction with customers. The system automatically checks stock availability, calculates totals, generates invoice numbers, and deducts stock.

7.1 Creating a New Sale

1	Go to Sales → New Sale
2	Select the Customer from the dropdown
3	Click 'Add Product' and select each item being sold. The dropdown shows current stock in brackets.
4	For each line: confirm Quantity and Unit Price
5	The Line Total and Grand Total calculate automatically
6	Apply Discount in UGX if authorized
7	Select Sale Type: CASH or CREDIT
8	Enter Amount Paid — for CASH sales this must equal the Grand Total
9	Select Payment Method: Cash, Mobile Money, or Bank Transfer
10	Enter a Payment Reference (mobile money transaction ID, etc.)
11	Add Notes if needed
12	Click 'Confirm Sale'

■ ■ WARNING The system will REFUSE the sale if: stock is insufficient, product is inactive, selling price is below cost price, cash sale has unpaid balance, or credit limit is exceeded.

7.2 Cash Sales

- Sale Type = CASH
- Amount Paid must equal the Grand Total exactly
- Payment Method is required (Cash, Mobile Money, Bank)

7.3 Credit Sales

- Sale Type = CREDIT
- Amount Paid can be zero (fully on credit) or a partial payment
- The unpaid balance is added to the customer's outstanding balance
- Existing balance + new sale must not exceed the customer's Credit Limit
- A due date is set automatically 30 days from the sale date
- Only Managers can override the credit limit restriction

■ **IMPORTANT** Before offering credit, always check the customer's outstanding balance first.
Go to Customers → Customer Name.

7.4 Processing a Sales Return

1	Open the sale (click its invoice number in the Sales list)
2	Click 'Process Return' in the breadcrumb bar
3	Enter the Reason for the return (minimum 5 characters)
4	Enter Return Quantity for each item — max is original qty minus already returned
5	Click 'Process Return' — stock is restored and customer balance adjusted

7.5 Sales List Columns

Invoice	Unique invoice number — click to open detail page
Customer	Who bought the goods
Type	CASH or CREDIT
Total	Grand total of the sale
Paid	Amount already paid
Balance	Amount still owed — shown in red if outstanding
Date	Date and time the sale was created
By	Staff member who processed the sale

8. CUSTOMERS MODULE

8.1 Adding a New Customer

1	Go to Customers → New Customer
2	Enter the Customer Name (required)
3	Select Customer Type: Walk-in, Retailer, Wholesaler, Distributor, or Business
4	Enter Telephone, Email (optional), and Address
5	Set Credit Limit — maximum UGX the customer can owe. Set to 0 for cash-only.
6	Enter Payment Terms e.g. Net 30 (optional)
7	Click Save — a Customer Number is assigned automatically

8.2 Customer Detail Page

Click any customer name to open their detail page. You will see full contact information, outstanding balance, all sales history, and all payments received.

8.3 Managing Customer Credit

Credit Limit	Set when creating/editing. Zero means cash-only.
Outstanding Balance	Updated automatically when credit sales made and payments recorded
To reduce balance	Record a payment against any outstanding invoice
View all credit customers	Reports → Customer Balances
Overdue balances	Reports → Customer Balances → tick 'Overdue only'

■■ **WARNING** A customer cannot receive more credit if existing balance + new sale > credit limit. A Manager can override this restriction.

8.4 Customer Statement

1	Open the customer's detail page
2	Click 'Statement' in the breadcrumb bar
3	Set the From and To date range
4	Click Filter

5

The statement shows all invoices, payments, and outstanding balance

9. SUPPLIERS MODULE

9.1 Adding a New Supplier

1	Go to Suppliers → New Supplier
2	Enter the Supplier Name (required)
3	Enter Contact Person — the representative you deal with
4	Enter Telephone, Email, Location, and Address
5	Enter Tax/Business Number if applicable
6	Enter Payment Terms (e.g. 'Cash on delivery', 'Net 7 days')
7	Click Save — a Supplier Number is assigned automatically

9.2 Supplier Detail Page

Click any supplier name to see their contact information and complete purchase history — all orders made from this supplier, their status, and total value.

9.3 Supplier Purchase Returns

Purchase returns are managed from the individual purchase order detail page, not from the Supplier page. Open the purchase order and click Process Return. See Section 6.4.

10. PAYMENTS MODULE

10.1 Recording a Payment

Recommended — from the Sale detail page:

1	Open the sale (click its invoice number in the Sales list)
2	Verify the outstanding Balance shown
3	Click 'Record Payment' in the breadcrumb bar (only visible if balance > 0)
4	Enter Amount — pre-filled with full outstanding balance, edit if partial
5	Select Payment Method (Cash, Mobile Money, Bank Transfer)
6	Enter Reference Number — mobile money ID, bank reference, etc.
7	Click 'Record Payment' — balance reduces, receipt number generated

■ **IMPORTANT** Always record payments against the specific invoice. This keeps customer statements accurate and allows proper reconciliation.

10.2 Payment Methods

Default methods: Cash, Mobile Money, Bank Transfer. To add a new method (e.g. Cheque):

1	Go to Administration → Payment Methods → New Method
2	Enter the Name and optional Description
3	Click Save

10.3 Payments List

Go to Payments to see all recorded payments. Each entry shows receipt number, customer, payment method, amount, reference, date, and the staff member who recorded it.

11. REPORTS MODULE

Provides management with accurate, timely information. All reports support date filtering and CSV export to Excel.

11.1 Sales Report

Shows all sales in a selected date range. Filter by customer. Export to CSV.

- Summary: Total Sales count, Revenue, Total Paid, Total Outstanding
- Click any invoice number to go directly to that sale
- CSV export downloads all filtered records as a spreadsheet

11.2 Inventory Report

Shows current stock levels and value for all products.

- Toggle 'Low stock only' to see only products at or below reorder level
- Total Stock Value shows the total inventory value at cost price
- Export to CSV for use in Excel or Google Sheets

11.3 Purchase Report

Shows all purchase orders in a date range, filterable by supplier.

- Summary: Total Orders, Total Purchase Value, Received Orders count
- Export to CSV

11.4 Customer Balances

Shows all customers with outstanding credit balances.

- Toggle 'Overdue only' to focus on overdue accounts
- Click 'Statement' to generate a customer's account statement

11.5 Customer Statement

Detailed statement for one customer showing all sales and payments in a date range. Access from Customer Balances or from the customer detail page.

11.6 Stock Movements Report

Complete audit trail of all stock changes. Filter by date range and movement type.

- Positive quantities (green) = stock in
- Negative quantities (red) = stock out

11.7 Audit Log

Records all important actions — who did what and when. Shows Date/Time, User, Action, Entity, and IP Address. Only visible to Administrators.

11.8 Exporting to CSV

Every report has a green CSV button. Click it to download the current filtered results as a .csv file. Open in Excel, Google Sheets, or any spreadsheet application.

■ **TIP** The CSV export respects your current filters. If you filtered by customer or date range, only those records are exported.

12. ADMINISTRATION MODULE

Restricted to Administrators and Managers. Covers user management, role configuration, and system settings.

12.1 Creating a New User

1	Go to Administration → Users & Roles → New User
2	Enter a Username — minimum 3 characters, no spaces, unique
3	Enter the user's Full Name
4	Enter their Email address (optional but recommended)
5	Select their Role — this determines what they can access
6	Set an initial Password (minimum 8 characters)
7	Click 'Create User'
8	Give the username and temporary password to the new staff member
9	Ask them to change their password immediately on first login

12.2 Editing & Deactivating Users

Editing:

- Click Edit next to any user
- You can change name, email, role, and reset password
- Username cannot be changed after creation

Deactivating (when staff member leaves):

1	Find the user in the list
2	Click 'Deactivate' button
3	Confirm the action
4	The user can no longer log in but their history is preserved

■■ **WARNING** Never DELETE users — only DEACTIVATE them. Deleting removes their name from historical records (sales, adjustments, audit logs).

12.3 Managing Roles

Administrator	Full access to everything — only assign to trusted senior staff
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Manager	Full operational access including approvals and overrides
Sales Officer	Sales, customers, payments, basic reports
Store Officer	Products, inventory, purchases
Accountant	Sales (view only), payments, financial reports

12.4 System Settings

Go to Administration → Settings to configure system-wide values such as currency, company name, and contact details.

1	Enter the Setting Key (e.g. currency, company_name)
2	Enter the Value (e.g. UGX, Ankole Soft Drinks Ltd)
3	Click Save — the setting updates immediately

13. USER ROLES & PERMISSIONS REFERENCE

13.1 Permission Matrix

The table below shows which permissions each default role has. ✓ = has permission, — = does not have permission.

Permission	Admin	Manager	Sales	Store	Accounts
dashboard.view	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
catalog.view	✓	✓	✓	✓	—
catalog.manage	✓	✓	—	✓	—
inventory.view	✓	✓	—	✓	—
inventory.adjust	✓	✓	—	✓	—
inventory.adjust.approve	✓	✓	—	—	—
inventory.count	✓	✓	—	✓	—
purchases.view	✓	✓	—	✓	—
purchases.manage	✓	✓	—	✓	—
purchases.receive	✓	✓	—	✓	—
sales.view	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
sales.create	✓	✓	✓	—	—
sales.discount	✓	✓	—	—	—
sales.credit.override	✓	✓	—	—	—
returns.manage	✓	✓	—	—	—
partners.manage	✓	✓	✓	—	—
payments.manage	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
reports.view	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
reports.export	✓	✓	—	—	✓
users.manage	✓	—	—	—	—
settings.manage	✓	—	—	—	—
audit.view	✓	✓	—	—	—

14. BUSINESS RULES REFERENCE

These rules are enforced automatically by the system. They cannot be bypassed by changing the user interface — all checks happen on the server.

BR-001	A sale CANNOT be completed if quantity requested exceeds available stock for any product. The error message names the product and shows available quantity.
BR-002	Only ACTIVE products can be sold. Inactive products are hidden from the sales form.
BR-003	Every confirmed sale automatically deducts stock and creates a permanent SALE stock movement record.
BR-004	Every confirmed purchase receipt automatically increases stock and creates a permanent PURCHASE stock movement record.
BR-005	Stock adjustments require: a positive quantity, a written reason (minimum 5 characters), and manager/administrator approval before stock changes.
BR-006	All access control is enforced on the server. Hiding a button on screen does NOT grant or remove permission.
BR-007	A credit sale is blocked if the customer's existing balance plus the new sale total exceeds their credit limit. Only staff with override permission can proceed.
BR-008	Cancelled transactions, rejected adjustments, and declined returns are preserved in the audit trail. Nothing is silently deleted.
BR-009	Completed sales cannot be directly edited. All corrections must go through the returns process.
BR-010	All logins, sales, purchases, adjustments, approvals, and setting changes are recorded in the audit log with user name, timestamp, and IP address.

15. TROUBLESHOOTING

15.1 Login Problems

"Invalid username or password"

- Check that Caps Lock is off
- Usernames are case-sensitive — use exactly the username assigned to you
- Contact your Administrator to reset your password

"Your account has been deactivated"

- Contact your Administrator to reactivate your account

15.2 Cannot Create a Sale

"Insufficient stock"

- The product has less stock than you requested
- Check Inventory to see the actual current quantity
- Create a purchase order to restock first

"Product is inactive"

- Go to Products, find the product, click Edit, and tick Active

"Credit limit would be exceeded"

- Record a payment from the customer first to reduce their balance
- OR ask a Manager to approve with credit override

"Selling price cannot be below cost price"

- Only Managers with the sales.discount permission can authorize below-cost sales

15.3 Stock Level Looks Wrong

1	Go to Inventory → Movements and filter by the product in question
2	Review all movement records — current stock is the sum of all movements
3	If a purchase was received but stock did not increase, check the purchase status — it may still be DRAFT
4	If stock is lower than expected, check for SALE or DAMAGE movements on the date the discrepancy started
5	If a correction is needed, submit a Stock Adjustment with a clear reason

15.4 Page Takes Long to Load

- The Render free hosting plan sleeps after 15 minutes of inactivity
- The first request after sleep takes 20-40 seconds to wake up — this is normal

- Subsequent pages load quickly once the server is awake
- To prevent this, upgrade to Render Starter plan (\$7/month)

15.5 Report Shows No Data

- Check that the date range includes the period you expect
- Verify filters are set correctly — dropdowns default to 'All'
- Confirm that transactions were actually completed (not in DRAFT status)

15.6 Cannot Approve Adjustment or Stock Count

- Only staff with the inventory.adjust.approve permission can approve
- If you cannot see the ✓ Approve button, you do not have this permission
- Ask your Administrator to assign the Manager or Administrator role

15.7 Getting Help

- Note the exact error message (take a screenshot if possible)
- Note what you were trying to do when the error occurred
- Contact your Administrator with both pieces of information
- The Administrator can check the Audit Log (Reports → Audit Log) for technical details

16. GLOSSARY

Adjustment	A controlled change to stock quantity, requiring a reason and manager approval
Audit Trail / Log	Automatic permanent record of who did what and when in the system
Balance	Amount a customer still owes on an invoice or across all invoices
BISMS	Beverage Inventory and Sales Management System — the name of this system
CASH sale	A sale where payment is made in full at the time of the transaction
Credit Limit	Maximum outstanding balance allowed for a credit customer
CREDIT sale	A sale where payment is deferred — the customer owes the balance
CSV	Comma Separated Values — a file format that opens in Excel and Google Sheets
Dashboard	The home page showing business KPIs and summary information
DRAFT	A purchase order created but delivery not yet confirmed
Inventory	The complete stock of products held by the business
Invoice	A document recording a sale transaction with a unique invoice number
KPI	Key Performance Indicator — a measurable value showing business performance
Reorder Level	Minimum stock quantity before the system generates a low-stock alert
RECEIVED	A purchase order where delivery has been confirmed and stock updated
Receipt Number	Unique number assigned to a payment record
Role	A named collection of permissions assigned to a user
SKU	Stock Keeping Unit — unique product code e.g. PEPS-500ML
Stock Movement	Any change to a product stock level — recorded automatically
UGX	Ugandan Shillings — the currency used in the system
Variance	The difference between system stock and physically counted stock

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